

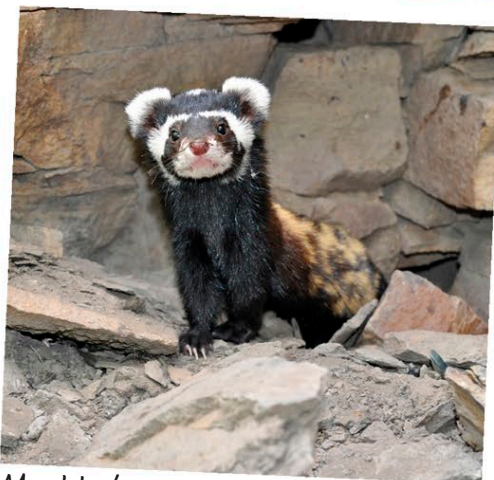
Gobi desert

The Gobi is Asia's largest desert. It spans more than 460,000 sq miles (1.2 million sq km). Temperatures here can be as scorching hot as 122°F (50°C) and as freezing cold as -40°F (-40°C), but many tough animal species are able to survive despite the extreme conditions.



Dinosaur fossil

The Gobi tells us a lot about prehistoric wildlife. Hundreds of dinosaur fossils of many types have been found here—including some from 250 million years ago! This was also first place in the world where dinosaur eggs were identified.



Marbled polecats are named after the pattern on their backs.

Gobi bear This is the Earth's rarest bear. Fewer than 50 Gobi bears remain in the desert, their only home.

Mongolian wild ass The wild ass waits for rare rain showers. After the showers, it can feed on fresh grass.

Mongolian marmot This rodent spends winters in its burrow, where it is safe from predators such as eagles.

Long-eared jerboa This tiny, mouselike jerboa hops around the desert at night, looking for tasty insects to eat.

Marbled polecat

This little predator doesn't see very well, but it has no trouble finding most of its prey by smell. It hunts rodents, birds, and reptiles—mostly during cool desert nights.

This jerboa's enormous ears are almost as long as its body! Scientists think they release heat, keeping the jerboa cool.